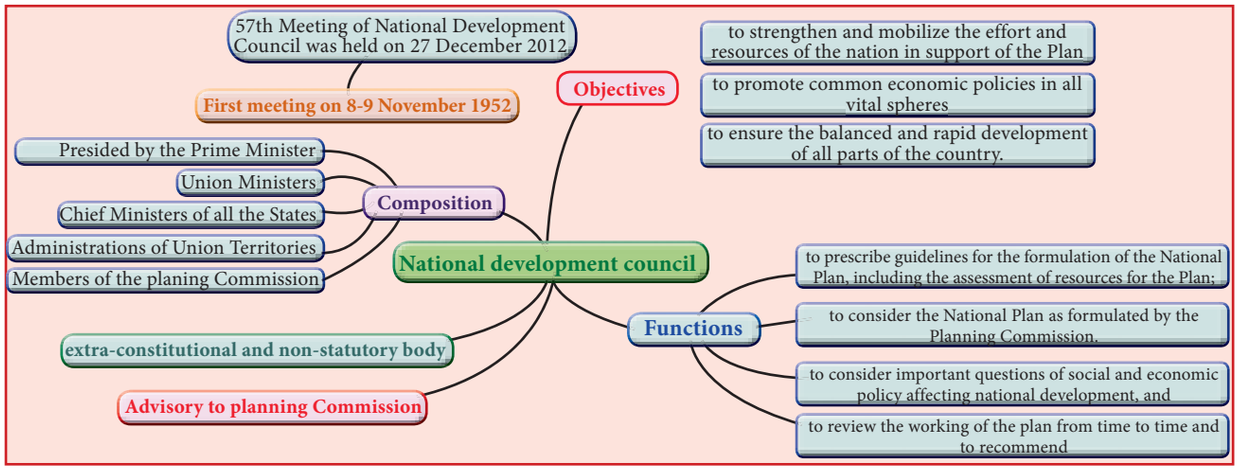


Activity

Interpretation of Cartoon

I am thinking of how to encourage our citizens to spend to get the economy moving.



As a class, discuss what you already know or think about the following topics:

1. Economic activities of the State
2. Social welfare of the people
3. Importance of economic development
4. Socio-economic justice
5. Employment

Efforts Towards Poverty Eradication

One of the major problems of India was poverty. The Planning Commission aimed not only at increasing the per capita income but also improving the quality of life of the people. Growth of the economy necessitated the inclusion of all sectors. It was also understood that the quality of life of the common man was interrelated to his economic conditions. So, it was realised by the state that it was important to guarantee people a decent standard of living along with proper access to education and health care which are next to food, clothing and shelter. But the challenge was that economic growth and reduction of poverty are not always related. From the fourth five year plan, the government focussed on this issue and concentrated on 'garibi hatao' during the early1970's.

Employment generation was considered to be one of the measures for reduction of poverty. There were many problems due to unemployment and underemployment. In all the five year plans emphasis was given to employment.

Ensuring Social Justice

Article 38(2) states "The State shall, in particular, strive to minimize the inequalities in income, and endeavour to eliminate inequalities in status, facilities and opportunities, not only amongst individuals but also amongst groups of people residing in different areas or engaged in different vocations". This was kept in mind by the planners in formulating each of the plans.

Ensuring social justice has gone hand in hand with economic planning. Along with measures for development, it is also

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